

2000-97

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

CFO-RC FILE X: _____ RESULTS: _____

Species (please include common and scientific name): Bell's Vireo (*Vireo bellii*)

Rid 1/14/00 uppe

Date(s) of Observation: June 13, 2000

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: Male Plumage: adult

Exact location: Unnamed island in the White River approximately 1/2 mile downstream from Kenney Reservoir. West of Rangely in Rio Blanco County.

Length of observation: approx. 5 minutes

Time(s) of observation: 7:40 a.m

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you:

Doug Faulkner initially identified the bird by its song.

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): None

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position): Good light. Partly cloudy. Sun behind the viewers.

Optical equipment used: 10x40 binoculars.

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 20 feet..

Was bird(s) photographed? No Have you submitted photos? No

Who took the photographs? N/A.

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Thicket of mixed riparian shrubbery with a Rio Grande Cottonwood overstory. The shrubs included coyote willow (*salix exigua*), Russian olive and other unidentified shrubs.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the species or in supporting the identification):

The bird sang regularly throughout the observation. It was actively foraging in the thicket. It fed in the interior of thick brush, allowing only brief glimpses.

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page 2

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):

A small vireo, about kinglet size, with a thick, short, vireo bill. Wings and tail grayish. Faint wingbar. Undertail coverts bright yellow. Belly paler yellow. Breast dingy whitish. Head grayish with faint light spectacles.

Describe birds call or song: Series of buzzy notes in a question and answer pattern of alternating final rising and falling terminal notes.

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

Ruby-crowned Kinglet. Buzzy song of the vireo is entirely unlike the clear, ringing song of the kinglet. This bird had faint spectacles rather than a clean white eye ring and lacked conspicuous wingbars.

What is your prior experience with this and similar-appearing species? Minimal experience with Bell's. I have seen a few in Minnesota at the northernmost point of their range. I have heard the bird in Oklahoma. I have seen and heard thousands of Ruby-crowned Kinglets.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None available until much later. Reviewed National Geographic to confirm field marks recorded after the observation.

This report was made from notes made **immediately following** the observation..

Date of written report: January 14, 2001.

Signature:

Reporting observer: Rich Leivad



Address: 564 B Villa St.

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Send report to: Colorado Birds Record Committee c/o Bill Lisowsky 2919 Silverplume Dr. Ft. Collins, Co. 80526